

MINUTES
VANCE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS
WORK SESSION
August 18, 2025

The Vance County Board of Commissioners held a work session on Monday, August 18, 2025 at 4:00 p.m. in the Commissioners' Conference Room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia Perry.

Absent: Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster and Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom. County Attorney Jonathan S. Care was absent.

Sheriff's Office Recruitment and Retention. Sheriff Curtis Brame appeared before the board with concerns over losing law enforcement officers to other agencies due to Vance County's low salaries. He stated that he has lost 10 deputies over the last year and noted that other agencies are paying \$3,000 to \$17,000 more than Vance County. He recommended the minimum salary be increased from \$46,266 to \$55,000 in order to recruit and retain officers. He asked for the board's support and asked for the opportunity to meet with the county manager to develop a plan to address this matter.

During discussion, Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt stated that a progression plan needs to be developed to address compression issues. County Manager C. Renee Perry agreed and added that an incentive plan would also be helpful to provide increases for advanced education, certifications, etc. Commissioner Brummitt requested staff to research and see if there are any grants that may be available to assist with this.

Ms. Perry stated that she would develop a plan for sworn officers and bring back to the board during its November regular meeting. For this, she stated that she would need data and requested the Sheriff to provide her with all current deputy applications and certifications.

Opioid Committee. Ms. Perry requested the board to establish the make-up of the opioid committee. Following discussion, the board agreed to the following:

- Three commissioners – Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain and Yolanda Feimster
- Health Department representative
- Vaya Health representative
- Sheriff's Office representative
- EMS representative
- Social Services representative
- Court System representative
- Two services providers
- Two community organizations
- Two lived experience individuals

As there was no further business, at 4:55 p.m., the work session was adjourned.